



The Five Most Popular Custom Android ROMs



Paranoid Android

A smartphone is almost indispensable to us today and Android smartphones dominate the market. However, the stock ROM provided by the manufacturer may not have all that a user may want to tweak the phone. So a custom ROM is the answer. Here are some reasons for using one, along with the five most popular custom Android ROMs.

Android for mobiles is a huge success and it has more than 80 per cent of the world smartphone OS market share. The mainstay of the Android ecosystem is that it is open source. This induces developers and hackers around the world to try to port every major Android release to most of the popular OEM devices.

Why flash custom Android ROMs?

A custom ROM is nothing but a fork of the Android version that runs on your device. Its main benefit is that it removes unwanted apps that take up precious storage space. The other advantage is that your device can get the taste of the latest Android versions that the OEM may or may not release for the device. By using a custom ROM, you will have multiple options to tweak or unlock the potential of the device by overclocking, personalising themes, adding private browsing support and so on. The custom ROM option has given a second life to once-popular devices like HTC HD2. There are chefs who still cook all the different flavours of Android for this particular device. Some of the popular custom ROM providers support most of the devices available in the market.

Stock ROM or the ROM that comes along with the device can be backed up to restore it at any point in time. There are apps that do this job perfectly, like ROM Manager, Titanium backup, CWM recovery, etc. The backed up ROM can be flashed back to the device to claim warranty. In order to flash a custom ROM, it is mandatory to root/unlock your phone. There are instructions available over the Net on how to do the job safely. One such

information hub is 'xda-developers.com' which provides information on rooting, unlocking and flashing custom ROMs on most of the devices.

Reasons for not flashing custom ROMs

Custom ROMs, though nice, have some drawbacks too.

Battery life: You have to choose wisely while flashing the custom ROM as most custom ROMs may not be optimised for your device and the ROM may use up your battery's power faster than the original ROM.

Bugs: Some of the custom ROMs may have bugs and lots of issues that will make you want to get back to the original ROM. There are some ROMs that may not have been properly cooked and may result in force-closing of some apps and random rebooting of the device.

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To avoid all these issues related to custom ROM, use some of the valid ROMs that have been well tested by the community and chefs to provide constant support. Some of them provide OTA support too.

Cyanogenmod

Cyanogenmod is one of the most popular Android Open Source Project (ASOP)-based custom ROMs. It runs on 5 million devices around the world. This ROM supports older devices and the latest ones. It is backed by numerous volunteers around the world. Most of the custom ROMs are cooked with Cyanogenmod as a base. Cyanogenmod takes the ASOP released by Google to the